

ENG508 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG508) Semantics and Pragmatics

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Lesson 01

INTRODUCTION TO SEMANTICS AND PRAGMATICS

Topic-001: Definition of Semantics and Pragmatics Learning Theories

What is semantics?

Semantics is the study of literal, de-contextualized, and grammatical meaning in language.

How is linguistic semantics defined?

Linguistic semantics is the study of how languages organize and express meanings.

What does semantics analyze in language?

Semantics analyzes the relationships between signs, symbols, and their representations.

Define pragmatics.

Pragmatics is the study of meaning as communicated by the speaker and interpreted by the listener.

How does Yule describe pragmatics?

Pragmatics is the study of "invisible" meaning, recognizing implied meaning beyond the literal words.

What does pragmatics consider in communication?

Pragmatics considers context, background knowledge, and cultural variations in communication.

What is semantics and what does it study?

Semantics refers to the branch of linguistics that concerns itself with the study of literal, de-contextualized, and grammatical meaning. It analyzes how languages organize and express meanings. Linguistic semantics explores the relationships between linguistic signs, symbols, and their representations.

Define pragmatics and its scope.

Pragmatics is the study of meaning as communicated by a speaker and interpreted by a listener. It delves into the "invisible" meaning that goes beyond the explicit words used. This field includes context, background knowledge, and cross-cultural variations in communication.

Topic-002: The Borderline between Semantics and Pragmatics

What does semantics study?

Semantics studies the contribution of linguistic items' meanings and their combinations to overall meaning.

Describe lexical semantics.

Lexical semantics deals with the meanings of individual words.

What is compositional semantics concerned with?

Compositional semantics studies how word meanings combine to form phrase and sentence meanings.

Where does pragmatics focus in relation to semantics?

Pragmatics focuses on the meaning conveyed by an utterance in a specific context after semantics.

Explain the difference between semantics and pragmatics.

Semantics is concerned with the meanings contributed by linguistic items and how they combine to form meaning. On the other hand, pragmatics deals with the meaning conveyed by an utterance in a specific context. Pragmatics takes over where semantics ends, focusing on context-specific interpretations.

Topic-003: Sentences and Utterances

What does semantics deal with in terms of linguistic entities?

Semantics deals with the meaning of sentences.

What is the distinction between sentences and utterances?

Sentences are abstract structures, while utterances are concrete instances of speaking or writing.

How does an utterance differ from a sentence?

Utterances have spatio-temporal and physical properties, whereas sentences do not.

What is the distinction between sentences and utterances in terms of semantics and pragmatics?

Semantics primarily deals with sentence-level meaning, studying the meanings of words and how they combine to form meaning. Pragmatics, however, centers around utterances – specific instances of speech or writing. Utterances have

additional attributes like spatio-temporal and physical properties, which sentences lack.

Topic-004: Language and Logic

What is the focus of logic?

Logic focuses on the relationships, combinations, and derivations of ideas.

What is the basic unit of traditional logic?

The basic unit of traditional logic is a "proposition."

What do logicians study in terms of meanings?

Logicians study meanings through propositions, which are the contents of thoughts expressed by declarative sentences.

Define compositionality.

Compositionality states that the meaning of a whole is composed by combining the meanings of its parts.

Explain the relationship between logic and linguistics.

A: Logic concerns itself with the ways in which ideas relate, combine, and derive further ideas. In linguistics, logic is important because it helps us understand how language expresses meaning through the composition of words and phrases. The basic unit of logic, the proposition, aligns with meanings expressed by sentences in language.

Topic-005: The Explicit and the Implicit

Define implicit meaning in pragmatics.

Implicit meaning is the intended meaning of a speaker that may differ from the literal meaning of words.

What does the difference between explicit and implicit meanings suggest?

The difference suggests the presence of shared pragmatic principles guiding intended interpretations.

Why are pragmatists interested in implicit meaning?

Pragmatists seek to understand the nature and extent of pragmatic principles and why speakers rely on implicit meaning.

What does the implicit meaning often convey?

Implicit meaning often conveys more information than what is literally expressed, making literal meaning underdetermined.

Define implicit and explicit meaning. How do they relate to pragmatics?

Implicit meaning refers to the unspoken intention a speaker conveys through their words, often diverging from the literal meaning of the words. Explicit meaning is the straightforward, literal sense of the words. Pragmatics explores cases where implicit and explicit meanings differ, seeking to understand shared pragmatic principles guiding interpretations. This field aims to uncover why speakers heavily rely on implicit meanings, which often convey more nuanced information than explicit meanings.

Lesson 02

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SEMANTICS AND LINGUISTICS

Topic – 006 Semantics in Linguistics

What is semantics?

Semantics is the study of meanings in language.

How does modern linguistics relate to semantics?

Modern linguistics examines pronunciation, sentence construction, and meanings in language.

What is the relationship between semantics and philosophy/psychology?

Semantics has connections to philosophy and psychology as they also investigate meaning creation and transmission.

What is semantics?

Semantics is a specialized term used to describe the study of meanings within language. This encompasses various aspects of language, although there isn't a universal framework to comprehensively describe it.

How does modern linguistics relate to semantics?

Modern linguistics encompasses a wide range of considerations related to language, including pronunciation, sentence structure, and meanings. Semantics plays a vital role in this by delving into the complexities of meaning representation.

Explain the relationship between semantics and philosophy/psychology.

Semantics shares connections with fields like philosophy and psychology, which also delve into the creation and transmission of meanings. However, it's important to note that an individual's meaning isn't always within the scope of general semantic studies.

Topic – 007 Semantics in a Model of Grammar

How does semantics relate to phonetics and grammar in linguistic models?

Semantics is often placed at one end of linguistic models, with phonetics on the other end and grammar in between.

What is the difference between word meaning and phrase/sentence meaning in terms of productivity?

Word meanings are more productive, allowing the creation of new words, while phrase/sentence meanings are less frequently changed.

According to Chomsky, what is the significance of sentence formation in generative grammar?

Chomsky emphasized that a small set of combination rules allows speakers to create a vast number of sentences from a finite set of words.

How does semantics fit within linguistic models alongside phonetics and grammar?

Semantics is often positioned at one end of linguistic models, with phonetics at the other end and grammar somewhere in between. This arrangement highlights the role of semantics in understanding meaning within language.

What distinguishes word meaning from phrase/sentence meaning in terms of productivity?

While word meanings are highly productive, allowing the generation of new words, phrase and sentence meanings are comparatively less dynamic and undergo changes less frequently.

What did Chomsky contribute regarding sentence formation in generative grammar?

Chomsky's significant insight is that a relatively small set of rules for combining words enables speakers to create an extensive array of sentences. These rules must facilitate recursion, enabling the embedding and coordination of syntactic categories.

Topic – 008 Historical Semantics

What does the term 'semantics' originally refer to?

Originally, 'semantics' referred to the development and change of meaning.

Give examples of semantic changes through generalization and specialization.

Generalization: 'arrive' from Latin 'arripere' (movement ending at a riverbank).
Specialization: 'girl' originally referred to 'children in general' but later to 'female children' only.

What is the role of taboo in meaning change?

Taboo often leads to the replacement of words used for unpleasant things, resulting in semantic changes.

What was the original meaning of the term 'semantics'?

Originally, 'semantics' referred to the study of the development and evolution of meanings over time.

Provide examples of semantic changes through generalization and specialization.

Semantic changes often occur through generalization, such as 'arrive' evolving from Latin 'arripere,' which initially referred to movement ending at a riverbank. Specialization is illustrated by 'girl,' initially meaning 'children in general,' but later narrowed to 'female children' only.

How does taboo contribute to meaning change?

Taboo plays a significant role in meaning change as words associated with unpleasant concepts are frequently replaced. This ongoing substitution results in the evolution of semantic content.

Topic – 009 Semantics in other Disciplines

Apart from linguists, which other disciplines are interested in semantics?

Philosophers, anthropologists, and psychologists also show interest in semantics.

How does psychology intersect with linguistics?

Psycholinguistics explores how language is processed in both production and reception, often influenced by behaviorist analyses.

What is the relationship between linguistics and anthropology?

Anthropologists consider language as a part of cultural and behavioral patterns, emphasizing its importance.

Beyond linguistics, which other disciplines show interest in semantics?

Semantics attracts attention from philosophers, anthropologists, and psychologists, who explore various aspects of meaning within their respective fields.

How does psychology intersect with linguistics?

Psycholinguistics is a field that explores the cognitive processes involved in language production and comprehension. The understanding of how language is processed is influenced by psychological perspectives.

Explain the relation between linguistics and anthropology.

Anthropology views language as a fundamental aspect of culture and behavior. This perspective, as championed by figures like Malinowski, underscores the importance of linguistic patterns in understanding societies.

Topic – 10 Semantics and Semiotics

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How does linguistic meaning relate to the broader human ability to use signs?

Linguistic meaning is a subset of the general human capacity to convey meanings through signs.

What is the term for the study of sign systems beyond language?

The study of sign systems beyond language is called Semiotics.

Explain the distinction between the signifier and the signified.

The signifier is a material thing that signifies, while the signified is the concept it refers to.

What are iconic signs, and provide an example.

Iconic signs resemble the signified. An example is a picture resembling its real-life subject.

What are indexical signs, and how do they work?

Indexical signs are caused by the signified, pointing to a connection between the signifier and its referent.

How does linguistic meaning relate to the broader concept of using signs?

Linguistic meaning is a subset of the broader human ability to communicate meaning through signs. This ability extends to various domains beyond language.

What is the overarching study that includes linguistic signs and beyond?

The study of sign systems beyond language is known as Semiotics. This field investigates the relationship between signs and the meanings they represent.

Explain the concept of the signifier and the signified.

The signifier is the material element, such as words, facial expressions, or images, that signifies a certain concept. The signified is the mental concept or idea to which the signifier refers.

Provide examples and distinctions among iconic and indexical signs.

Iconic signs resemble what they signify. For instance, a picture resembles its real-life subject. Indexical signs, on the other hand, are caused by the signified, showing a connection between the signifier and its referent. An example of an indexical sign is a smoke sign indicating fire.

Lesson 03

IMPORTANT ASSUMPTIONS ABOUT SEMANTICS

Topic 11: Reference and Sense

What were the terms "reference" and "sense" introduced by?

Friedrich Ludwig Gottlob Frege in "On sense and reference" (1892).

Define "reference" according to Lyons and Saeed.

Reference: The relationship between an expression and what it stands for during utterance. (Lyons, 1977; Saeed, 2004)

What does "sense" represent according to Allan and Saeed?

Sense: Decontextualized meaning abstracted from linguistic occurrences, involving intra-linguistic relations. (Allan; Palmer, 1981; Saeed, 2009)

Question: What are the terms "reference" and "sense," and who introduced them?

The terms "reference" and "sense" were introduced by Friedrich Ludwig Gottlob Frege in his work "On sense and reference" in 1892. Reference refers to the relationship between an expression and what it stands for during utterance. Sense, on the other hand, is a decontextualized meaning abstracted from linguistic occurrences.

Topic 12: Utterance, Sentence, and Proposition

What is a "proposition" according to Haug?

Proposition: A declarative sentence that expresses a true or false statement about the external world. It's the lowest level of language. (Haug, 2014)

Differentiate between a "sentence" and a "proposition."

Sentence: A grammatical string of words adhering to language rules. (Huang, 2014)

Proposition: The meaning-bearing unit within a sentence, existing in the lexicon.

How is "utterance" defined by Leach and Huang?

Utterance: A speech unit, spoken or written, in a specific context. (Leach, 1981; Huang, 2014)

How does Haung define "proposition," and what role does it play in language?

Haung defines a "proposition" as a declarative sentence that conveys a true or false statement about the external world. It is the lowest level of language, existing as a meaning-bearing unit. Propositions are words that reside in the lexicon and hold meaning.

Differentiate between a "sentence" and a "proposition."

A "sentence" is a grammatical string of words adhering to language rules. It is a higher-level language construct that can encompass multiple propositions. A "proposition," however, is the meaning carried by a sentence, residing in the lexicon and expressing a true or false statement about the world.

Define "utterance" according to Leach and Huang, and explain its importance.

An "utterance" is a natural speech unit, whether spoken or written, and it's bounded in articulation. It represents the most concrete level of language, conveying specific meanings in a given context. It encompasses various linguistic elements such as words, phrases, sentences, or even sequences of sentences. Utterances are often enclosed in inverted commas to indicate their contextual origin.

Topic 13: Activities on Utterance, Sentence, and Proposition

Can utterances consist of a single word or a sequence of sentences?

Yes, utterances may consist of a single word, phrase, sentence, or sequence of sentences.

Is there a simple correspondence between utterances and sentences?

No, there's no simple correspondence between them.

Provide full sentences for the given utterances:

(1) Fred: 'In 1832, Goethe died.'

(2) Guest: 'I would like coffee, please.'

(3) B: 'The battle of Waterloo was won by Wellington.'

Can utterances consist of various linguistic elements? Provide examples.

Yes, utterances can consist of a single word, a phrase, a sentence, or even a sequence of sentences. For instance, "Hello," "Not much," and "I am reading the novel" are all examples of different types of utterances.

Explain the relationship between utterances and sentences.

Answer: There isn't a simple one-to-one correspondence between utterances and sentences. An utterance can encompass a single sentence or span multiple sentences. Additionally, utterances can even include grammatically incomplete sentence-fragments, showcasing the complexity of this relationship.

Topic 14: Literal and Non-Literal Meaning

Define "literal meanings" and provide an example.

Literal Meanings: Conventional, factually accurate meanings of words. (Saeed, 2003)

Example: "I am hungry."

What are "non-literal meanings" and give an example?

Non-Literal Meanings: Untrue or figurative meanings for special effects. (Saeed, 2003)

Example: "I could eat a horse."

Define "literal meanings" according to Saeed, and provide an example.

"Literal meanings" are conventional, factually accurate meanings of words. These meanings describe the word's reference in the real world. For example, the phrase "I am hungry" carries a literal meaning where hunger is being expressed.

What characterizes "non-literal meanings," and offer an example.

"Non-literal meanings" involve using words or phrases in a way that goes beyond their conventional or factual sense. They include figurative language devices like metaphor, irony, and metonymy. For instance, the expression "I could eat a horse" is non-literal, signifying extreme hunger.

Topic 15: Semantics and Pragmatics

What are the three schools of thought on semantics and pragmatics distinction?

Semanticism, Pragmatism, and the combined view.

Explain the semanticism viewpoint.

Semanticism: Semantics, morphology, and syntax are pure linguistics; pragmatics is excluded.

Describe the pragmatism perspective.

Pragmatism: Semantics deals with conceptual meaning, but pragmatic context is essential for complete meaning.

What does the combined view suggest about semantics and pragmatics?

Both are important. Semantics offers literal meaning, and pragmatics provides non-literal and social context meaning.

Explain the three different viewpoints on the distinction between semantics and pragmatics.

Answer: The three viewpoints are:

Semanticism: Only semantics, morphology, and syntax are considered pure linguistics; pragmatics is excluded.

Pragmatism: Pragmatics plays a crucial role, as real conversations occur within its realm, ensuring complete meaning.

Combined View: Both semantics and pragmatics are important. Semantics deals with literal meaning, while pragmatics provides context-based and non-literal meanings.

How do semantics and pragmatics contribute to meaning in language according to the combined view?

Answer: In the combined view, semantics provides literal meanings of words and sentences, focusing on language-specific meaning. Pragmatics, on the other hand, addresses the speaker's meaning within the social and contextual framework, dealing with non-literal meanings and implications.

Lesson04

THEORIES OF MEANING

Topic 16: What Is Meaning?

What is the field of study that deals with meaning?

Semantics deals with the study of meaning.

How does the verb 'mean' have multiple meanings?

The verb 'mean' has multiple meanings or senses in the dictionary.

Provide examples of sentences illustrating different meanings of 'mean.'

Examples include sentences like "I mean to be there tomorrow," "What I mean to do" (intention), "That cloud means thunder," and "A red light means 'Stop'" (sign both natural and conventional).

How is meaning connected to language?

A: Meaning is connected to language through the lexicon and grammar, as well as how we use language.

What are sense relations? Provide examples.

Sense relations include synonymy, antonymy, hyponymy, etc. For instance, 'big' and 'large' are synonyms, while 'happy' and 'sad' are antonyms.

What does the field of semantics entail and what does it study?

Semantics is the study of meaning in language. It explores how words, phrases, and sentences convey meaning and how this meaning is interpreted by language users.

How does the verb 'mean' demonstrate multiple meanings?

The verb 'mean' has various senses or meanings. For instance, it can refer to intention (e.g., "I mean to be there tomorrow"), indication (e.g., "That cloud means thunder"), or conveying a sign (e.g., "A red light means 'Stop'").

How is meaning linked to language and what components are involved?

Meaning is closely tied to language through the lexicon (collection of word meanings) and grammar (structure and rules for combining words). Additionally, meaning is shaped by how language is used in communication.

Topic 17: Meaning Holism – Meaning within Language

What is meaning holism?

Meaning holism is the idea that the meaning of a word, phrase, or sentence depends on its relationship with other words in the language.

How does holist theory view the meaning of language?

Holist theory suggests that a piece of language derives its meaning from its usage and context.

How do critics respond to the idea of meaning holism?

Critics argue that language is not as arbitrary as holism predicts, and that there are consistent patterns in how languages express meaning.

What limitation prevents meaning holism from being a basis for scientific study?

Meaning holism lacks a foundation for the scientific study of linguistic meaning.

Explain the concept of meaning holism and its implication for language.

Meaning holism posits that the meaning of a linguistic unit is influenced by its relationship with other elements in the language. This suggests that understanding the meaning of a word or sentence requires considering its connections within the linguistic system.

How does meaning holism view the role of language usage in determining meaning?

Meaning holism emphasizes that meaning is not isolated to individual words or sentences. Instead, meaning emerges from the way language is used in various contexts, reflecting its functional role.

What are the criticisms against meaning holism?

Critics argue that meaning holism underestimates the structured and non-arbitrary nature of language. They contend that languages exhibit consistent patterns and reveal deeper linguistic universals, challenging the notion of pure arbitrariness.

Topic 18: Idea Theory of Meaning

What does the Idea Theory of Meaning propose?

The Idea Theory suggests that meanings are concepts, thoughts, or ideas in the mind.

What challenges does the Idea Theory face?

The Idea Theory struggles to provide a sound psychological theory of concepts and needs to account for all meaningful language expressions.

How are concepts formed according to the Idea Theory?

Concepts are formed through people's experiences, which can vary from person to person.

What does the Idea Theory of Meaning propose regarding the nature of meaning?

The Idea Theory suggests that meanings are rooted in concepts, thoughts, or ideas within the human mind. It posits that understanding language involves grasping the mental representations associated with linguistic expressions.

What challenges does the Idea Theory face in explaining linguistic meaning?

The Idea Theory encounters challenges in providing a comprehensive psychological basis for concepts and in accounting for the diversity of meaningful language expressions.

How does the Idea Theory connect the formation of concepts with individual experiences?

According to the Idea Theory, concepts are shaped by individuals' unique experiences. This implies that the meaning of a word or expression may vary based on personal encounters and interpretations.

Topic 19: Meanings Are out in the World

How do certain philosophical views suggest that meanings are "out in the world"?

Some theorists believe that meanings are part of social practices and language games.

What does the view of language as not arbitrary social conventions imply?

This view contradicts the idea that languages are purely social conventions; instead, languages reveal deeper universal patterns reflecting the way human minds are structured.

What is the reference theory of meaning?

The reference theory of meaning suggests that the meaning of a word is shown by what it denotes in the real world.

Describe the viewpoint that meanings are embedded in social practices.

Some philosophical views suggest that meanings are part of social practices and language games. This perspective sees linguistic communication as participating in a structured language game with predefined rules.

How does this viewpoint clash with principles of modern linguistics?

This view contradicts the idea that languages are purely arbitrary social conventions. Modern linguistics contends that languages exhibit underlying cognitive structures and universal patterns that are not solely products of social agreements.

Explain the concept of reference as a theory of meaning.

The reference theory posits that the meaning of a word is linked to what it refers to in the real world. Proper names refer to specific individuals, while common nouns refer to categories of entities.

Topic 20: Meaning of Sentences and Truth Conditions

What does the theory of truth conditions emphasize?

A: The theory emphasizes that the meaning of a sentence is tied to the conditions under which it is true or false.

What is a proposition in the context of truth conditions?

A proposition expressed by a sentence is a set of possible worlds where the sentence is true.

Can the meaning of questions be defined in terms of their possible answers?

Some scholars find it challenging to define the meaning of questions solely in terms of possible answers.

How does the theory of truth conditions relate to the meaning of sentences?

The theory of truth conditions emphasizes that the meaning of a sentence is intricately connected to the conditions under which it can be considered either true or false.

What is a proposition in the context of truth conditions?

In the context of truth conditions, a proposition refers to the meaning expressed by a sentence. It encompasses a set of possible worlds in which the sentence is true.

What challenge does defining the meaning of questions based on possible answers pose?

Defining the meaning of questions solely through possible answers is complex due to the intricate relationship between question structures and the range of potential responses.

Topic 21: Putting Meaning Together from Pieces - Compositional Theory

What is the principle of compositionality?

The principle of compositionality states that the meaning of a piece of language comes from the meaning of its parts and how they are combined.

How does the compositional theory explain the creativity of language?

The theory explains language's infinite creativity by relying on the principle of compositionality.

How does the relationship between syntax and semantics affect understanding?

The relationship highlights that understanding sentence structure involves understanding the roles of components like nouns, verbs, adjectives, etc.

Explain the principle of compositionality and its significance.

The principle of compositionality asserts that the meaning of a larger linguistic unit (e.g., a sentence) is composed of the meanings of its individual parts (e.g., words) and their grammatical relationships. This principle is crucial in understanding how sentences convey coherent meanings.

How does the compositional theory address the creative nature of language?

The compositional theory explains language creativity by suggesting that novel expressions are understood based on the meanings of their constituent parts and their arrangements, in line with the principle of compositionality.

How does the interplay between syntax and semantics contribute to linguistic understanding?

The relationship between syntax (sentence structure) and semantics (meaning) is integral. To comprehend sentence structure, one needs knowledge of grammatical components (nouns, verbs, etc.) and their semantic roles, highlighting the symbiotic nature of these two aspects of language.

Lesson 05

KINDS OF MEANING

Topic 22: Linguistic/Conceptual Meaning

What is linguistic meaning also known as?

Denotative, logical, or cognitive meaning.

How many levels are necessary for linguistic competence in language?

At least three levels.

What are the three levels necessary to generate or understand linguistic utterances?

Phonological representation, syntactic representation, and semantic representation.

What does conceptual semantics aim to provide?

The semantic representation of a sentence using abstract symbols and contrastive features.

Why is conceptual meaning important in language?

It helps distinguish the specific meaning of a sentence from other possible meanings.

What is linguistic meaning also referred to as, and what does it entail?

Linguistic meaning is also known as denotative, logical, or cognitive meaning. It encompasses the definition found in the dictionary. A piece of language operates on multiple levels, requiring at least three levels: phonological representation, syntactic representation, and semantic representation. These levels are necessary for generating and comprehending linguistic utterances. One level can be derived from another during analysis.

Topic 23: Connotative/Referential Meaning

What does connotative meaning refer to?

The communicative value of an expression beyond its conceptual meaning, based on what it refers to.

What types of properties can connotative meanings include?

Physical, psychological, and social properties.

How are connotative meanings related to real-world experiences?

They relate to the experiences associated with the expressions used or heard.

What distinguishes conceptual meaning from connotative meaning?

Conceptual meaning is about language itself, while connotative meaning deals with the real world.

What is connotative meaning, and how does it differ from conceptual meaning?

Connotative meaning pertains to the communicative value attributed to an expression beyond its conceptual meaning. It involves what an expression refers to and includes physical, psychological, and social properties. Connotative meanings are linked to real-world experiences associated with expressions. Conceptual meaning focuses on language itself, while connotative meaning extends to the real world and the feelings it evokes.

Topic 24: Social Meaning

What does social meaning in language convey?

Information about the social circumstances of language use.

How do we decode the social meaning of a text?

By recognizing dimensions and levels of style within the language.

What role does the usage of language play in determining meaning?

It's determined by social factors like social class and formality.

Provide examples of words at different levels of formality.

Domicile (Very Formal), Residence (Formal), Abode (Poetic), Home (General).

What does social meaning in language convey, and how is it deciphered?

Social meanings convey information about the social context of language use. We decode social meaning through recognizing dimensions and levels of style within

language. Certain words or pronunciations may reveal dialectal origins or a speaker's social or geographical background. Additionally, features of language may indicate the social relationship between the speaker and the listener. The scale of language usage, from formal to colloquial, also plays a role in conveying social meaning.

Topic 25: Affective Meaning

What do affective meanings reflect?

Personal feelings and attitudes of the speaker.

How can affective meanings be conveyed?

Through conceptual or connotative content of words, intonation, and tone of voice.

What are some examples of elements used to express emotions in language?

Interjections like Aha! and Yippee!

What do affective meanings reflect, and how are they conveyed?

Affective meanings reflect the personal feelings and attitudes of the speaker. They can be conveyed through the conceptual or connotative content of words, as well as through factors like intonation and tone of voice. The norms of politeness and cultural differences can influence affective meanings. Elements such as interjections ("Aha!" and "Yippee!") can also express emotions directly in language.

Topic 26: Reflected and Collocative Meaning

What are reflected meanings in language?

Meanings associated with one sense of expression based on another sense.

How do reflected meanings arise?

In cases of multiple conceptual meanings, one sense influences another sense.

What is an example of reflected meaning with taboo words?

Taboo words often have reflected meanings through strong emotive suggestion.

What are collocative meanings?

Meanings influenced by words commonly occurring in the same context.

What are reflected meanings and how do they emerge?

Reflected meanings involve associating one sense of an expression with another. These meanings arise in cases of multiple conceptual meanings, where one sense influences another due to its relative frequency, familiarity, or emotional associations. For instance, taboo words often carry reflected meanings due to their strong emotive suggestion.

What are collocative meanings, and how do they develop?

Collocative meanings arise from associations that a word gains based on the words it typically occurs with. For example, words like "pretty" and "handsome" share a similar meaning ground ("good-looking"), but they can be distinguished by the range of nouns they commonly co-occur with. Collocative meanings can be considered idiosyncratic properties of individual words.

Topic 27: Thematic Meaning

How can sentences with similar conceptual meanings differ in communicative value?

Based on the way they're organized in terms of order, focus, and emphasis.

What does thematic meaning depend on?

Choice between alternative grammatical constructions and sometimes stress and intonation.

What role does grammatical construction play in thematic meaning?

It can highlight information by organizing the message in a specific way.

How can sentences with similar conceptual meanings differ in communicative value?

Sentences with similar conceptual meanings can have different communicative values based on how they're organized in terms of order, focus, and emphasis. Thematic meaning, a matter of choice between alternative grammatical constructions, plays a role here. It involves the way a speaker or writer arranges a message, highlighting certain information through grammatical structure, stress, or intonation.

What role does thematic meaning play in language?

Thematic meaning involves the organization of a message in terms of grammatical construction, order, focus, and emphasis. It helps convey not just what is said, but how it is presented. Sometimes, thematic meaning is conveyed through stress and intonation, emphasizing particular parts of a sentence. It impacts how a message is understood and interpreted by listeners or readers.

Working on the Next Lessons

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